

STAGE THIRTEEN • TEAMWORK & COLLABORATION

FIRSTS

Teamwork & Collaboration

SESSION 1

Team Foundations

FIRSTS Q1-Q10

Team Formation

- Deliberate beats default, every time
- Proximity $\neq$ genuine shared objective
- Foundation for the whole section

Team Goal Alignment

- A shared brief $\neq$ shared interpretation
- Confirm explicitly, don't assume
- A costly, entirely avoidable problem otherwise

Team Roles Defined

- Unclear roles → duplication or real gaps
- Knowing your own role isn't enough
- Fast exercise, high leverage

Team Working Agreement

- Mismatched expectations breed friction
- Explicit norms, not assumed ones
- Cheaper to set now than fix mid-project

Collaborative Planning Session

- Built together beats handed down
- More realistic, more genuinely owned
- Presenting for approval misses real input

Collaborative Brainstorming Session

- Structure beats unstructured discussion
- Separate generation from judgment
- A genuinely learnable skill

Shared Decision-Making Exercise

- Silence $\neq$ agreement
- Confirm buy-in actively, especially quieter voices
- Stronger commitment to actually executing it

Team Task Delegation

- Fit and fairness, not who spoke first
- Prevents uneven workload at scale
- Scales Q3's clarity into real assignment

Team Accountability System

- Visible, not just a leader's job
- Peer-shared systems catch slipping commitments
- Extends Q4 into an operational tool

Team Check-In

- Lightweight beats full meeting, every time
- Catches small obstacles before they grow
- Closes the section into a sustainable rhythm

SESSION 2

Working Together in Practice

FIRSTS Q11-Q20

Collaborative Problem-Solving Exercise

- Collective often beats individual, done right
- Structure prevents one voice dominating
- Scales Q7's shared decisions further

Team Documentation System

- One owner → documentation goes stale
- Shared ownership keeps it current
- Supports Q9's accountability directly

Collaborative Digital Workspace

- Partial adoption recreates the original problem
- Confirm the whole team actually uses it
- An adoption check, not just tool selection

Cross-Functional Team Experience

- Genuine translation, not assumed shared vocabulary
- A skill built through sustained experience
- First of three FIRSTS on real difference

Multicultural Team Experience

- Diverse perspectives are a genuine strength
- Your default style isn't culturally neutral
- Requires real awareness, not assumption

Remote Team Experience

- Informal cues are mostly lost remotely
- More deliberate communication required
- Closes the Q14–Q16 arc on genuine difference

Asynchronous Collaboration Exercise

- Genuinely different from real-time work
- Self-contained writing, not “ask me later”
- Breaks down without that discipline

Team Handoff

- A brief verbal summary isn't enough
- Context only becomes visible once someone picks it up
- High-leverage skill beyond this stage

Peer Review Within a Team

- Catches issues earlier than leader-only review
- Builds a shared standard of quality
- Specific, actionable, not vague

Team Feedback Session

- Proactive, not just reactive to problems
- Builds a genuine culture of improvement
- Scales Q19 into a full team practice

SESSION 3

Navigating Difficulty & Closing Out

FIRSTS Q21-Q30

Team Conflict Resolution

- Not only a designated leader's job
- Any team member can add real value
- Peer-level counterpart to Stage Twelve

Difficult Teammate Experience

- A specific behavior, not the whole person
- Professionalism despite genuine friction
- A distinct, valuable skill

Team Consensus Exercise

- A majority vote $\neq$ genuine consensus
- Unaddressed dissent can undermine execution
- Harder, but stronger follow-through

Team Compromise

- Not every disagreement reaches consensus
- Genuine, not forced or one-sided
- Keeps the team moving forward

Team Recognition Practice

- In the moment, not just at the end
- Specific beats generic praise
- Builds real, ongoing morale

Team Celebration

- Shared milestones build shared memory
- Easy to skip in the rush to the next task
- Doesn't need to be elaborate

Team Retrospective

- Honest, not just what went well
- Turns experience into real, future learning
- Sets up Q29's lesson-learned document

Team Performance Assessment

- Collective, not leader-only
- Shared ownership of both wins and shortfalls
- Peer counterpart to Stage Twelve's review

Team Lesson-Learned Document

- Memory fades; documents don't
- Specific, actionable, not vague
- Extends Q27 into lasting use

High-Performing Team Experience

- Deliberate, not accidental
- Combine practices, don't apply them in isolation
- Closes the entire stage

Stage Thirteen, Complete

One team practice, named out loud, that you're committing to keep using.